

The Academic Paper is 4,000 - 5,000 Words and consists of the following components.

Elements of the Academic Paper

Components	Description
Introduction and Literature Review	-Introduces research question/project goal and reviews previous works in the field. -Synthesizes the varying perspectives in the scholarly literature to situate the research question/project goal within a gap in the current field of knowledge.
Method, Process, or Approach	-Explains and proves justifications for the chosen method, process, or approach.
Results, Product, or Findings	-Presents the findings, evidence, results, or performance/exhibit/product.
Discussion, Analysis, and/or Evaluation	-Interprets the significance of the results, performance/exhibit/product, or findings; explores connections to the original research question/project goal.
Conclusion and Future Directions	-Articulates the new understanding generated through the research process and the limitations of the conclusion or creative work. -Discusses the implications to the community of practice. -Identifies areas for future research.
Bibliography	-Provides a complete list of sources cited and consulted in the appropriate disciplinary style.

75% of a student's score consists of a 4,000-5,000 word academic paper.



Read Sample Paper A (scored high on the AP Rubric) and take some notes. You can write about anything you want but here are some questions to consider:

What do you notice?

They went out and did their own research. That is pretty crazy. They contacted 54 places in Connecticut, obtained Institutional Review Board (IRB) approval, conducted interviews, distributed surveys, and reviewed menu items at facilities. The structure is very formal and is presented like a published academic journal. It is very specific; they did not try to answer "Is the Mediterranean Diet Good for Alzheimer's?" That has been researched previously. Rather, they identified a gap where no one had checked whether facilities used the Mediterranean Diet. The quote(s) from interviews in the Appendix were my favorite part. One person discussed that the sweet taste bud is the last one to go; therefore, residents simply desire cookies and ice cream throughout the day. These little bits of humanity bring everything alive.

What questions does this paper raise for you about research?

I am interested in finding out how they received IRB approval as a high school student as that seemed quite difficult. I would also love to know how long the entire data collection process took for them to contact facilities and follow-up on voicemail messages. How do you find a valid survey instrument that can be adapted for your own study?

How is this paper different from the IRR and IWA?

The student is creating new knowledge. This paper includes a methodology and a results section containing original data that hasn't been collected previously, unlike the IWA and IRR, where you synthesize sources and make an objective claim. The IRR and IWA are analyzing

existing source information, while a research paper actually creates new information and analyzes data that may or may not have been synthesized in this specific way (to fill a gap).

How does this paper influence your thinking about your own research?

My research question will need to be much more specific than I originally planned. The student, for example, asked one small question and provided a comprehensive answer for that one question. I would like to do the same thing with my research topic.